Xray for Jira Cloud

Advanced Topics 12–21 — Concepts, Definitions, Examples, Revision Notes

Beginner-friendly companion material for the numbered topics supplied by the learner.

Important: Xray Cloud menus and feature availability vary by plan, permissions, Jira layout, and product rollout. If a menu is missing, check the current official documentation and ask your Jira/Xray administrator.

12. Test Repository

Definition: The Test Repository is Xray's hierarchical way to organize Test issues in folders and subfolders. It helps teams browse and maintain a large test library.

Why it matters

- Organizes Tests by product area, feature, module, or test type.
- Makes large collections easier to find and maintain.
- Repository folders are for hierarchical organization; they do not themselves store pass/fail results.

Example folder	Possible contents
Online Store / Authentication	Login, logout, password reset
Online Store / Checkout	Cart, address, payment, order confirmation
Online Store / Admin	User administration and product management

Repository vs Test Set

Test Repository	Test Set
Hierarchical folders/subfolders	A flat, named collection of Test issues
Good for long-term library navigation	Good for reusable groups of selected Tests
Not itself a test execution result	Does not directly report pass/fail results

Best practices

- Use stable, understandable folder names.
- Avoid excessive nesting.
- Use Test Sets when you need a reusable flat group for selection.
- Use Test Executions/Test Runs to track results.

13. Test coverage in Xray

Definition: Test coverage describes the relationship between requirements or other coverable Jira issues and the Tests that verify them. It answers: which requirements have tests, and which still have gaps?

13.1 Enabling coverage

- A Jira/Xray administrator may need to enable requirement coverage for the project.
- Check that requirement issue types such as Story, Task, or custom requirement types are configured as coverable in Xray settings.
- If you cannot see administration settings, ask an administrator; do not assume coverage is enabled.

13.2 Mapping tests

- Open a requirement issue, such as STORY-10.
- Use the Tests/coverage section or supported issue-link control to link the Test that verifies it.
- Open the Test and verify that the requirement relationship appears.
- Link only Tests that genuinely validate that requirement.

13.3 Viewing report

- Open Xray Reporting Center or the coverage report available in your instance.

- Choose the relevant coverage/traceability report and select the correct project/scope/version if requested.
- Generate the report and inspect requirements with linked Tests and requirements with no linked Tests.

> Coverage is not the same as pass rate. A requirement can have linked Tests that are failing or not yet executed. Check coverage and execution results separately.

Requirement	Linked Test	Interpretation
STORY-10 Login	TEST-21 Valid login	Covered by a Test
STORY-11 Password reset	None	Coverage gap
STORY-12 Lockout	TEST-22 Lockout behavior	Covered; check execution status separately

14. Defect mapping in Xray

Definition: Defect mapping connects a failed Test Run to a Jira defect/Bug so the team can trace a test failure to the work item used to investigate and fix the problem.

Typical workflow

- Run the Test and compare actual behavior with the expected result.
- Set the Test Run to FAIL and record the actual result/evidence.
- Create a Bug from the Test Run or link an existing Bug using the supported action.
- Verify the link from the Test Run to the Bug.
- After a fix, rerun the Test in an appropriate execution and record the new result.

Useful defect details

- Clear title and reproduction steps.
- Expected versus actual result.
- Environment/build/browser/device.
- Screenshots, logs, and relevant Test/requirement links.

> A failed test is not always a product defect. Test data, environment instability, automation issues, or incorrect test steps may also cause failure.

15. Test environment

Definition: A Test Environment records the context where a Test is run, such as browser, operating system, device, server configuration, or deployed build.

15.1 Enabling environment

- Check Xray settings/features for Test Environments and configure them if required.
- Some configurations use predefined environment values; available fields and setup can vary.
- Administration permission may be required.

15.2 Linking environments to executions

- Open/create a Test Execution.
- Find the environment selector/field supported by your Xray setup.
- Select or enter a consistent value, such as Chrome / Windows 11 / Staging build 105.
- Save and verify that the value is retained on the execution or supported Test Run details.

15.3 Using in reports

Environment data helps explain why the same Test behaves differently on different systems. Some reports may show or filter by environment; others may not. Check the report's supported fields or use a configurable document template.

Execution	Environment	Purpose
EXEC-101	Chrome / Windows 11 / Staging	Desktop web test
EXEC-102	Safari / macOS / Staging	Browser compatibility
EXEC-103	Android / App build 2.4	Mobile validation

16. Custom fields in Xray

Definition: Custom fields are Jira fields created to capture team-specific information. Depending on field type and configuration, they may be available on Tests, Test Executions, Test Plans, or Xray Test Run details.

Examples

- Automation Status: Manual / Automated / Planned
- Test Layer: UI / API / Database
- Test Priority: P0 / P1 / P2
- Test Data Owner: responsible person/team

How custom fields work

- Create/configure the field with the correct type and context.
- Add it to the relevant issue screen or Xray-specific field configuration.
- Test the field on a sample issue and confirm it saves.
- Check whether the field is usable in filters, reports, or document templates if needed.

A Jira issue custom field and an Xray Test Run custom field may be configured differently. Confirm exactly where you want the field to appear before configuring it. Avoid creating fields for information already covered by standard fields.

17. Importing test in Xray

17.1 Preparing test cases

- Prepare a supported spreadsheet/file with clear Test summaries and one record per Test.
- Prepare manual steps in the structure expected by the selected importer (for example Action, Data, Expected Result).
- Check required fields, project, Test Type, duplicate rows, special characters, and relationship columns.
- Keep a backup and test a small sample first.

17.2 Importing tests to Xray

- Choose the import flow that supports your source format and Test type.
- Upload/select the file and map columns to Jira/Xray fields and step fields.
- Review preview and validation warnings.
- Run the import and save the created issue keys/result summary.

17.3 Confirming the import

- Search for imported Test issues.
- Open samples and verify summary, description, type, steps, expected results, metadata, and relationships.
- Compare source record count with created issue count and review warnings.

• Confirm imported Tests can be found and added to a Test Set, Test Plan, or Test Execution.

Importing test definitions is different from importing automated execution results. Different formats and workflows may be required.

18. Test Execution List, Test Plan List, Test Run List, Tests List, Test Set List

List	What it shows	Typical use
Test Execution List	Execution issues and run scope/results	Find a run for a build or regression cycle
Test Plan List	Plans and their planned/aggregated scope	Review release testing progress
Test Run List	Individual Test results inside executions	Inspect status, evidence, actual result, defects
Tests List	Test issues/specifications	Search, edit, filter, organize Tests
Test Set List	Test Set issues and grouped Tests	Reuse groups of Tests

Lists may be available through the Xray Testing Board, navigation pages, or Jira issue search. A Test Run is generally a result instance inside a Test Execution, not a separate Jira issue with its own issue key.

Use lists effectively

- Filter by project, status, version, label, or available fields.
- Use JQL for searchable Jira issue types/fields.
- Open an item to see full details; list columns may omit fields.
- If no separate Test Run list is exposed, open a Test Execution and select its Test Runs.

19. Test coverage report

19.1 Test coverage

Shows requirement-to-Test relationships and helps find requirements without linked Tests. The exact scope and calculation depend on the report.

19.2 Test Plan metrics

Summarizes the Test Plan’s progress/results using its associated Tests and Test Executions. Review pass/fail/not-run or other available status counts and confirm the correct scope.

19.3 Traceability

Traceability links requirements, Tests, execution results, and defects. It lets a team follow what should work, what tested it, what happened, and which Bug tracks a failure.

Question	Look at
Does every requirement have a Test?	Coverage report and requirement/Test links
Are we ready for release?	Plan metrics, execution progress, open failures/defects
Why did validation fail?	Test Run result, evidence, linked Bug
Which tests belong to the release?	Plan/Execution scope and version fields

Coverage is about relationships; plan metrics are about progress/results; traceability is about following links among artifacts.

20. Xray dashboard

A Jira dashboard is a page of gadgets summarizing issues or metrics. Xray reporting gadgets and availability depend on your installation and enabled features.

20.1 Creating

- Open Jira Dashboards and choose Create dashboard or copy an existing one.
- Give it a descriptive name such as QA Release Overview.
- Set dashboard permissions for the intended viewers.

20.2 Adding gadgets

- Choose Add gadget and search for Xray or relevant reporting gadgets.
- Add and configure gadgets for the correct project/filter/plan/execution.
- Arrange the most decision-useful metrics first.
- Check that the gadgets show data for the intended scope.

20.3 Publishing

In Jira, publishing often means sharing the dashboard with users/groups through dashboard permissions. Some Xray reports also offer a shareable report URL. Confirm the audience can access both the dashboard and the underlying Jira data.

Dashboard tips

- Show progress and risk: execution status, coverage gaps, open defects, and not-run Tests.
- Use consistent scope across gadgets.
- Avoid adding every available metric; keep the dashboard actionable.

21. Document Generator in Xray

Definition: Document Generator creates a document snapshot from selected Jira/Xray data using a template. It may produce test specifications, plan summaries, execution reports, or traceability documents depending on available templates.

21.1 Setting up template

- Check whether Document Generator is available and whether you have template/admin permission.
- Open Xray Reporting Center or Xray global settings and find Document Generator templates.
- Use an existing template or create/customize one in the supported format.
- Check expected issue types, link types, fields, and template variables.
- Test the template on a small known set of issues.

21.2 Generate documents

- Open the supported issue, search results, or Xray screen that defines the report scope.
- Choose Document Generator/export.
- Select the template, output format (such as DOCX/PDF where supported), and file name/options.
- Generate and download the document.

21.3 Viewing document reports

- Open the generated file and check issue keys, steps, links, results, and dates.
- Confirm the report includes the expected Tests and fields.
- If a section is blank, check template variables, permissions, selected issues, and template assumptions.
- Record the generation date and scope; a document is a snapshot, not a live dashboard.

Document Generator is different from a dashboard gadget. Some sites use Xporter, a separate app with its own template/export workflow. Confirm which product your Jira site actually has.

Quick revision: which feature answers which question?

Need	Use
Organize a large test library	Test Repository
Group a reusable collection	Test Set
Find requirements with no Tests	Coverage report
Track a failed run to a Bug	Defect mapping
Record browser/device/build context	Test Environment
Capture team-specific metadata	Custom fields
Bring external cases into Xray	Import
Review status/progress	Lists and Test Plan metrics
Share team metrics	Dashboard and gadgets
Create a formal snapshot	Document Generator

Official references

- Xray Cloud documentation
- Reporting Center
- Xporter Test Report template
- Xray Cloud repository/coverage/reporting guidance